without regular access to her husband, though she lived only a few kilometres from his lodging—a prison—she had to coordinate complicated legal proceedings that would only further worsen their already dire financial situation.[80] Two weeks later, she was writing to another friend in Tirunelveli who was evidently helping her in the litigation; anxiety compounded by frustration is writ large in this epistle.[81] A few weeks later, she was still writing to the lawyer—thanking him for appearing in court on her husband's behalf—trying to figure out how the process was unfolding, going back and forth between prison, lawyer and family.[82]

A letter written to their trusted family friend C.K. Subramania Mudaliar of Coimbatore makes for distressing reading. While asking him for a copy of the Indian Companies Act 1882, Meenakshi wanted to know if, in the event VOC was unable to settle the dues demanded by the liquidator, could the court initiate distraint proceedings right away or would any other legal procedure precede it? Further, could he find 'a generous person' who would advance a loan for Rs 2,000 on a promissory note executed by VOC based on immovable assets worth Rs 4,000? The catch was that though the assets had no encumbrance, according to the family partition deed, VOC's mother Paramayi Ammal was entitled to the benefits of the property until her death following which it would become his freehold. VOC's mother would bear witness and surety for this loan which would be settled, she said, within a month of VOC's release from prison. The trauma undergone by Meenakshi can scarcely be imagined. The liquidation proceedings had come as a final blow towards the end of his prison term, when every means had been exhausted.[83]

In October, Meenakshi was writing to an unknown addressee asking him to mediate with the liquidator for time and for suspension of distraint proceedings. Because the only property left was the one in which his mother had an interest, VOC was asking for time—a month to settle the dues. The distraint proceedings, he had warned, would not yield fruit. His concern was about his honour and pride which would be tarnished by such proceedings.[84]